

bowler-turned-coach Frank Tyson worked with many young Indians during his time at the BCA-Mafatlal bowling scheme during the early 1990s, and from among them has a candidate he rates as, "one of India's young coaches of the future".

Paras Mhambrey, 35, had a brief stint with India but has made coaching his full-time vocation. In the summer, he plays as overseas pro and part-time coach for a club in England. In India's winter, he serves his apprenticeship as a professional coach. He spent two seasons with Bengal, along with captain Deep Dasgupta shepherding them into two consecutive Ranji finals, before moving to Vadodara. A good organiser and communicator, Mhambrey has remained a student in cricket.

POLICY AND PLANNING

SANJAY MANJREKAR

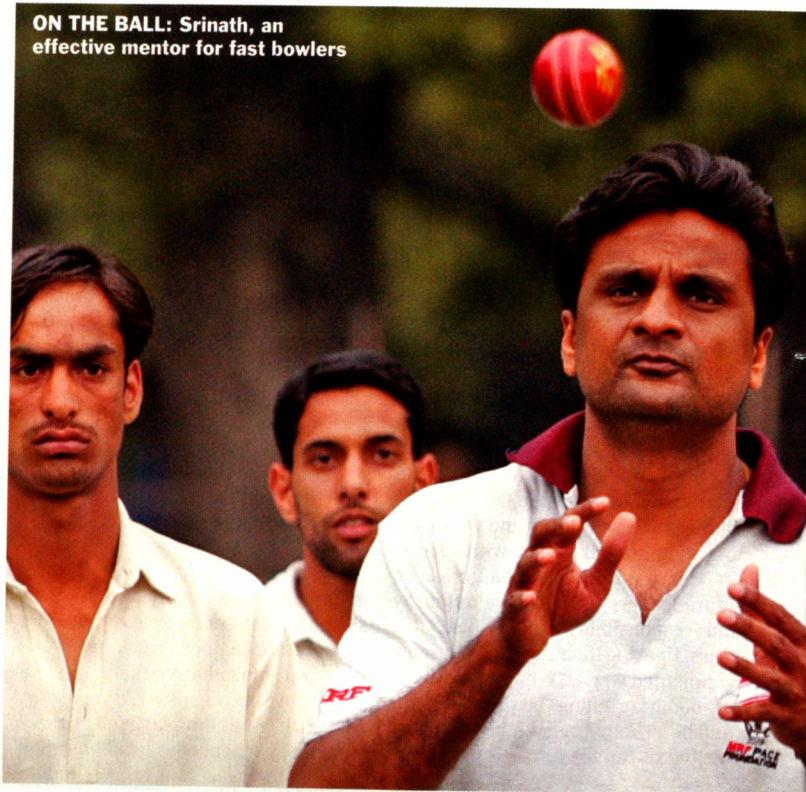
India's cricket has enough marketing wizards, spin doctors and TRP magnets. What it could really use is a thinker, a functioning bulls**t-meter and people not afraid to look back and forward with objectivity. Cricket on TV seems to have only one philosophy these days: that the only expert worth hiring is an ex-player who will act like the idiot on the idiot box. Instead of

THINK TANK:
Manjrekar is
high on reality



BHASKAR PAUL

ON THE BALL: Srinath, an effective mentor for fast bowlers



sagely opinion-makers, the cricket media is peopled with mob-leaders.

In this melee, Sanjay Manjrekar's is one of the few measured voices. If the BCCI were to convene a think tank to chart out plans for Indian cricket, they would do well to sweep their table clean of the usual suspects and ask Manjrekar, 41, to head it. A composed and competent top-order batsman for India, Manjrekar is the kind of man who is the first to admit that his career wasn't as successful as it could have been, and to then explain the reasons why. Indian cricket and the BCCI usually don't do introspection, but Manjrekar has never been afraid to.

In a recent column he wrote, "Stagnation' is a more accurate description of the current situation than 'crisis'... we have had some proud moments but after all these years, India needs to have a memorable era."

Low on rhetoric, high on reality, Manjrekar may be right or he may be wrong but he knows how to make you stop and think. He knows, more than TRP magnets, how to think.

FAST BOWLER DEVELOPMENT

JAVAGAL SRINATH

Javagal Srinath, 37, has always been a bit of a fast-bowling fundamentalist. The former India bowler-turned-commentator-cum-columnist and now ICC match referee never thinks twice about asking batting-obsessed India to contemplate the lot of the fast bowler. He will forever champion their cause, whether it is in preparing wickets to suit them, or playing five bowlers instead of the four, or, like he did in the last days of his international career, being the best kind of mentor to the younger bowlers in the team.

Srinath's understanding of the mysterious zone that is the mind of the fast bowler, the uses as well as the limitations of technology and biomechanics in fast bowling mean that there are few better than him to be put in charge of a fast-bowling development programme.